

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN KOSOVO

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Community action shapes what gets built in Kosovo, and one decade-long campaign against a coal plant showed that a broad, persistent civil-society movement can help kill a project a government had championed for years — above all by cutting off its money. For more than a decade, successive governments planned a large new lignite power plant near Pristina, Kosova e Re, "New Kosovo," to sit alongside the country's aging and notoriously polluting coal plants. It had a foreign developer on a long concession, and, for years, the backing of the World Bank. It looked unstoppable. But a coalition of Kosovar civil-society organisations opposed it for almost a decade — on the cost to households and the state, on the harm to a population already breathing some of Europe's dirtiest air, and on a flawed and opaque approval process. They did not win with a single blow. They built the case, year after year, that the plant was too expensive and too dirty; that case helped move the World Bank to withdraw its support, and the main European development bank followed; they took the flawed environmental approval to court and to a European energy body; and when the economics of coal collapsed and a new government opposed the deal, the developer, unable to find new financing, finally walked away. The plant was cancelled. The details are worth setting down, because they show how such a project is starved. The plan for a new lignite plant near Pristina went back more than a decade, and had at one point been imagined on an ambitious scale that would turn the country into a regional power exporter; over the years, a lack of investors, a lack of demand, and steady resistance whittled it down to a single plant of around 450 megawatts net, contracted in 2017 to a foreign developer on a twenty-year build-and-operate concession. For much of that time its indispensable backer was the World Bank. But the case the coalition built — that renewables had become cheaper than coal, that the guaranteed power price and the state guarantees would burden households and the budget for decades, that the plant would poison an airshed already among Europe's dirtiest — gradually did its work: in 2018 the World Bank confirmed it would not support the project, on the ground that coal was no longer the least-cost option; the main European development bank likewise declined; and without them the developer could not refinance. When the environmental approval was pushed through without proper public consultation, the coalition sued and complained to the European energy body; and when a new government took office opposed to the deal, the developer, out of money and milestones, exited the project — and coal altogether.

The Kosovo story teaches two things about stopping destructive projects here — including its honest limits, which this guide states plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever — the affected public, the documentation, the coalition, the financing, and the courts — pressed together over the long haul. The second is distinctly Kosovar, and it killed a coal plant. **A persistent civil-society coalition can stop a big, internationally financed project by making the case — on cost, on health, on a flawed process — that cuts off its money, and by keeping that pressure on for as long as it takes.** That power — the case on cost and health, the cutting-off of the financing, the flawed process challenged, and the persistent coalition — is Kosovo's distinctive lever, and this guide is built around it. What made the Kosova e Re campaign work as a model, and what a later community can copy, was the way it aimed its case not only at the government and the public but at the money. A big project of this kind lives or dies on its financing, and its financing — when it comes from international development banks — is governed by rules those banks must follow and reputations they must guard. By building an unanswerable case that the project was not the least-cost option, that it carried legal and reputational risk from a flawed approval, and that it would poison an already dirty airshed, the coalition turned the lenders' own standards against the project and cut off its lifeline. Make the case that starves the financing, challenge the flawed process that adds the legal risk, and sustain it until the money walks: that is the template — with the honest caution that the win was shared with the economics and the politics, and that the lever works only where a project depends on money that can be cut off.

But the same story carries honest warnings, and this guide will not hide them. The cancellation was a **confluence**, not a solo victory: the civil-society campaign was real and important, but so were the collapsing economics of coal, the withdrawal of the international lenders, and the arrival of a government opposed to the deal — the plant's death was over-determined, and honesty requires saying so. It is worth being candid about this from the start, because it neither diminishes the campaign nor lets it claim more than its due. The civil-society coalition did indispensable work — it built the cost-and-health case over years, it helped move the lenders, it challenged the flawed approval in court and in Europe, and it kept a centrepiece project under pressure for nearly a decade. But the plant also died because the economics of coal collapsed as renewables grew cheaper, because the international lenders withdrew, and because a new government came to office opposed to the deal; each of these mattered, and the campaign fed and was fed by them rather than acting

alone. A community that understands this fights more wisely: it does not imagine its protest alone will topple a project, but works to shift the economics, move the financiers, and win the political argument, so that when the moment comes the project is friendless — which is exactly what happened to Kosova e Re. The win was, in part, **defensive**: the new plant was stopped, but the old, dirty plants still run, and the underlying energy and air problem is unresolved. And the decisive lever — **cutting off the international financing** — worked because this project depended on international lenders, which not every project does. This guide is written with both truths in view: the real, distinctive power of the cost-and-health case, the financing lever, and a persistent coalition — and the confluence, the defensive nature, and the financing-dependence that qualify them.

Most communities do not know HOW to make that power effective. They face a big project the government has championed and assume "the money is lined up and the deal is signed and nothing can be done," and never attack the financing, never build the enduring coalition, never challenge the flawed process. They generate private worry without a sustained case. The gap between a project stopped and one built is rarely apathy — Kosovo's civil society proved a coalition will fight for a decade. It is method: knowing how to make the cost-and-health case, cut off the money, challenge the process, and endure.

This guide shows what actually works — inside the Kosovar and European system as it is.

The Strategic Framework

Effective campaigns follow the same underlying pattern, whether the goal is to stop a coal plant, a mine, or another destructive project:

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STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION (find the project, the money, and the leverage)
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STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION (build the case on cost, health, and process)
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STEP 3: LOCAL OPPOSITION (build the broad, persistent coalition)
|
STEP 4: LEGAL CHALLENGES (the courts, the process, and the European bodies)
|
STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY (make it a national and international cause)
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These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. Documentation feeds the financing argument and the public case at once; the coalition endures; a lawsuit or a lender's exit is a headline and a headline sustains the coalition. The community that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, over years, is the one that wins — a project's money cut off, its process challenged, the project killed. The Kosova e Re campaign did exactly this — it made the cost-and-health case, cut off the financing, challenged the process, and endured.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Kosovo's give communities a distinctive set:

- **The cost-and-health case.** A project's **ruinous cost and its harm to health** can be made the case that turns opinion and lenders against it, as at Kosova e Re.
- **The financing.** A big project that depends on **international lenders** can be stopped by **cutting off that money**, as the World Bank's and the European bank's exits helped do. This is the lever that most distinguishes a Kosovar fight of this kind, and it is worth understanding why it is so potent. A large plant is enormously expensive, and a government rarely funds one from its own budget; it turns to international development banks and foreign financiers, whose money comes with conditions. Those institutions are bound by their own lending rules — a least-cost test, environmental and social standards, legal-risk assessments — and they answer to reputations and to member governments increasingly wary of coal. A campaign that can show, with rigour, that a project fails those tests — that it is not the cheapest option, that it carries legal risk from a flawed approval, that it is environmentally indefensible — gives the lenders both reason and cover to withdraw. And a big project stripped of its international financing, as Kosova e Re was, often cannot proceed at all. Identifying the financing and turning the lenders' own standards against the project is therefore central to the Kosovar fight.
- **The flawed process.** A **flawed or opaque approval** — a defective environmental assessment — can be **challenged in the courts and European bodies**, as at Kosova e Re.
- **The persistent coalition.** A **broad civil-society coalition**, sustained for a decade, can outlast a government's determination, as KOSID did.
- **The European dimension.** As an aspirant bound by **European energy and environmental rules**, Kosovo is open to those levers, as at Kosova e Re.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers deliver a clean solo win. The Kosova e Re cancellation was a **confluence** of causes; the win was in part **defensive**, with the old plants still running; and the financing lever worked because the project **depended on international money**. This guide takes those limits seriously, names them plainly, and shows you how to use the real, distinctive tools Kosovo offers — the cost-and-health case, the financing lever, the process challenge, and the persistent coalition — as the opponents of Kosova e Re used them, while facing the confluence and the unfinished business honestly.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides your project's fate, at which level, and where along that path the project — or the leverage — is weakest. And map the money, because in Kosovo the financing is often where a big project is most vulnerable.

The Levels of Decision

A Kosovar project like this runs through several tracks at once, and each is a place to intervene.

The government and the ministries. The **government and the energy and environment ministries** drive and sign the big projects — and can be moved by the public, the coalition, the cost, and a change of government, as a new government's opposition helped end Kosova e Re.

The financing. The **international lenders and the financing** are, distinctively, the lifeblood of a big project — and cutting them off can kill it, as the withdrawal of the World Bank and the European bank did at Kosova e Re. It is worth grasping why the financing is so often the weakest point of a big project, because it shapes where a campaign concentrates its force. A government may be determined, a developer contracted, and an approval issued, and yet none of that builds a plant without the money to pay for it — and when that money comes from international lenders, it is subject to scrutiny and standards that the government and the developer cannot control. The lenders can be shown that a project is uneconomic, or legally risky, or environmentally indefensible, and they can walk; and once they walk, a project that cannot refinance is stranded, whatever the government's wishes. This is why a campaign should map the financing early and precisely — who is lending, on what terms, under what rules — and aim a large part of its effort at that lifeline, for it is often where a seemingly unstoppable project is in fact most exposed.

The approval and the assessment. The **permits and the environmental assessment** are open to objection and, if flawed, to challenge in the courts and European bodies, as the flawed assessment was challenged at Kosova e Re.

The developer and the contract. The **developer and its concession** drive the project — but a developer that cannot finance the project, or faces an opposed government, may walk away, as the developer did.

The public and the coalition. The **public, the civil-society organisations, and the persistent coalition** are the force that makes the case, cuts off the money, challenges the process, and endures — the force that helped kill a coal plant.

The Journey of a Project

A typical project moves from a government plan, through **a developer, a concession, financing, and permits**, toward construction — with the **public, the courts, the lenders, and the European bodies** able to object, challenge, and withdraw at any point. **Every one of those stages is a door you can put your foot in**, and the financing stage is the door many campaigns overlook. The distinctive Kosovar doors are the **cost-and-health case**, the **financing**, the **flawed process**, and the **persistent coalition**. Find out exactly where the project stands, and, crucially, **whether it depends on international financing that can be cut off, whether the cost and the health harm can be made the case**, and **whether the approval process is flawed and challengeable**, because those are often where a big project can be stopped.

Follow the Project, the Money, and the Process

Behind a project stand a proponent — the state, a developer — and the money that makes it possible. Trace who decides, who profits, and — importantly in Kosovo — **who is financing it and whether that financing can be cut off, what it will cost the public and what harm it will do to health, whether the approval process is flawed**, and **what the project does to the air, the land, and the people**. Two questions unlock most Kosovar fights of this kind: **Does it depend on international financing that a strong cost-and-health case can cut off?** and **Is the approval process flawed, and can it be challenged?** The financing and the cost-and-health case are, together, the heart of most such

Kosovar campaigns. These two reinforce one another in a way particular to the Kosovar fight: the cost-and-health case supplies the substance — the proof that the project is too expensive and too dirty — and the financing supplies the pressure point where that substance bites hardest, because it is precisely on cost and environmental harm that the international lenders’ own rules turn. A campaign with a strong case but no financing to aim it at may persuade the public and still see the project built; one that aims at the financing without a rigorous case has nothing to move the lenders. Joined together — an unanswerable case on cost and health, aimed squarely at the money — they can starve a project to death, as they starved Kosova e Re. And behind both stands the persistent coalition, without which neither the case is built nor the pressure sustained across the years the fight requires.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that can check the deciders, because they are levers too. The **courts**; the **international lenders**, whose own rules can turn them against a project; the **European bodies** — the energy and environmental frameworks Kosovo is bound to; the **civil-society organisations**; the **free press**; and the **public**, whose case on cost and health endures. In Kosovo, the **cost-and-health case, the financing, the flawed process, and the persistent coalition** are the most distinctive and decisive levers. Each is a separate front, and a project whose cost and health harm are exposed, whose financing is cut off, whose flawed process is challenged, and which faces a persistent coalition rarely survives — as Kosova e Re did not.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit months — or years — of effort, calibrate honestly. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how Kosovar and comparable campaigns tend to go, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the project **depends on international financing** that can be cut off, whether a strong **cost-and-health case** can be built, whether the **approval process is flawed** and challengeable, and whether a **persistent coalition** can be sustained. Where the project depends on international money and the case is strong, Kosovo's levers are real, as Kosova e Re shows; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the cancellation was a confluence of causes, that the win was in part defensive, and that the financing lever works only where a project depends on money that can be cut off.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	5–10%	ongoing	low	Basis for every other step
The cost-and-health case	45–70%	years	low	The argument that turns opinion and lenders
Cutting off the financing	50–75%	years	low–moderate	Lenders withdraw; the project starves
Challenging the flawed process	35–60%	1–3 years	moderate	The approval delayed or undone
The persistent coalition	45–70%	years	low	A movement that outlasts the government
The European bodies	35–60%	1–3 years	low	European rules brought to bear
Media & public pressure	45–70%	ongoing	low	A national and international cause
All steps (finance-dependent, strong case)	45–70%	years	low–moderate	Financing cut off; project cancelled
All steps (self-financed, weak case)	20–45%	years	low–moderate	Delay; the record; the case made

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Kosovo's real strengths are distinctive — the **cost-and-health case**, the **financing lever**, the **flawed-process challenge**, and the **persistent coalition**. Its constraints are specific: the win may be a **confluence** of causes; it may be **defensive**; and the financing lever needs a **finance-dependent project**.

A note on cost: making the case, building the coalition, cutting off the financing, and challenging the process cost mainly time, endurance, and expertise, and Kosovo's active civil society and its European ties supply real strength. Legal and European challenges carry costs, often met by the organisations and their international allies. But the expenditure that most changes outcomes is the endurance of the coalition and the rigour of the cost-and-health case, exactly what the

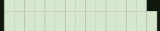
opponents of Kosova e Re sustained for a decade.

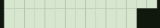
Effectiveness Visualization

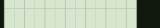
SUCCESS PROBABILITY (project's financing cut off, process challenged, project stopped)

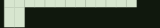
FINANCE-DEPENDENT + STRONG COST/HEALTH CASE + PERSISTENT COALITION:

All steps combined:  45-70%

Cutting off the financing:  50-75%

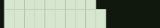
Cost-and-health case:  45-70%

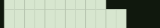
Persistent coalition:  45-70%

Single step:  5-75%

SELF-FINANCED / WEAK CASE -- no external money to cut, thin coalition:

All steps combined:  20-45%

Process challenge + delay:  the levers that remain

The case + the record:  more achievable than a full stop

Single step:  5-45%

How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in Kosovo are **cutting off the financing, the cost-and-health case, the flawed-process challenge, and the persistent coalition**. Kosova e Re shows the ceiling — and its honest shape: a strong case on cost and health, the withdrawal of the international lenders, a flawed process challenged, and a persistent coalition helped kill the plant, but the cancellation was a confluence, not a solo win, and the old plants still run. Most Kosovar fights of this kind sit between, and the honest lesson is that the financing lever and the cost-and-health case are powerful — decisive where a project depends on international money and the case is strong, weaker where a project is self-financed or the case thin, where the realistic win is delay, a record, and the case made. Read the table, then, as a diagnosis of your own position: a campaign against a project that depends on international financing, with a rigorous case on ruinous cost and severe health harm and a coalition able to sustain it, is in the stronger band and can aim to cut off the money and help kill the project, as at Kosova e Re; a campaign against a self-financed project, with a thin case or a thin coalition, is in the weaker band and should aim realistically at delay, a record, and the case made, while still building the coalition and challenging the process. Knowing which band you are in keeps a campaign both ambitious where the money is vulnerable and the case strong, and realistic — and enduring — where the ground is harder.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The cost-and-health case and the financing** — Kosovo's most distinctive levers; the case on cost and health that cuts off the international money, as at Kosova e Re.
2. **The persistent coalition** — the broad civil-society coalition sustained for a decade, as KOSID was.
3. **The flawed-process challenge** — the lawsuit and the European complaint over a defective approval, as at Kosova e Re. The value of the flawed-process challenge is not only that it may delay or undo an approval, but that it converts a governance failure into a concrete legal risk that the financiers must weigh. An environmental assessment adopted without the public consultation the rules require is not merely bad practice; it is a defect a court or a European body can be asked to remedy, and a risk a prudent lender must factor into its decision. So the challenge does double duty: it fights the approval on its own terms, and it signals to the lenders that the project is legally unsound. At Kosova e Re, the coalition's lawsuit over the flawed assessment and its complaint to the European energy body did exactly this. A campaign should therefore mount the process challenge both for its own sake and as a means of reinforcing the pressure on the money.
4. **The European bodies** — the European energy and environmental rules brought to bear.
5. **The media and public pressure** — the national and international cause that keeps the pressure on.

What Kosovar Campaigns Actually Show

A few patterns recur. **Cost and health move opinion and lenders** — the case that the plant was too expensive and too dirty turned the argument. **Cutting off the financing starves a project** — the lenders' withdrawal was decisive. **A flawed process can be challenged** — the defective assessment was taken to court and to Europe. **A persistent coalition outlasts a government** — a decade of opposition wore the project down. **But the win was a confluence, and defensive** — economics, politics, and financing all played their part, and the old plants remain. The through-line: **make the cost-and-health case; cut off the financing; challenge the flawed process; build the persistent coalition** — because in Kosovo a sustained civil-society campaign can starve a big project of its money and help kill it, even if the win is shared and the work unfinished.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective campaign begins by finding the exact project and financing that govern the threat — and the leverage the community holds, which in Kosovo is often the international money and the cost-and-health case. Vague opposition goes nowhere; a fight aimed at "the coal plant that depends on World Bank money, that will cost households dearly and poison the air, on a flawed approval" is a campaign — the kind that helped kill Kosova e Re. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

1. Does it depend on international financing? This is the first Kosovar question of this kind. Does the project rely on **international lenders** — development banks, foreign financiers — whose money can be **cut off**, as Kosova e Re depended on the World Bank and the European bank. Assess this honestly and early, because in Kosovo the degree to which a project depends on international money is what most shapes what is achievable through the decisive lever. Where a large project relies on development banks or foreign financiers — as most big power plants and infrastructure schemes must — the campaign has a lifeline to aim at, and the lenders' own rules to turn against it. Where a project is funded domestically, or by financiers indifferent to environmental and reputational risk, that lever is weaker, and the campaign must lean harder on the courts, the public, and the political argument. A community should therefore establish, first, exactly who is financing the project and how vulnerable that financing is, for on that answer the strength of the whole strategy may turn.

2. What will it cost, and what harm to health? What is the **cost to the public** — to households and the state — and the **harm to health** — the air pollution, the disease — that can be made the case, as they were at Kosova e Re. These two arguments — cost and health — are worth building with special rigour, because they are the ones that travel furthest across the audiences that matter. The cost argument reaches the finance ministry, the lenders' analysts, and every household that will pay the bill; the health argument reaches the public, the medical community, and a wider world watching how a country treats its air. Together they make a project indefensible on the two grounds hardest to dismiss — money and human health — and they do so in terms that a development bank's own standards are bound to weigh. A campaign that documents both to a high standard, and keeps the evidence current, arms every one of its fronts at once; this is why the cost-and-health case sits at the very centre of the Kosovar fight.

3. Is the approval process flawed? Is there a **flaw** — a defective or opaque environmental assessment, a lack of public consultation — that can be **challenged in the courts and European bodies**, as at Kosova e Re.

4. Can a persistent coalition be built? Can a **broad civil-society coalition** be built and **sustained for the long haul**, as KOSID was for nearly a decade.

5. Who decides, who benefits, and who can be engaged? Which developer, ministry, and lender are behind it, who profits; and which courts, European bodies, organisations, press, and public can be engaged.

A Worked Example

Suppose a large, internationally financed project is planned, on a flawed approval, with a high cost and a heavy harm to health.

Working the five questions: does it depend on **international financing**? What is the **cost and the health harm**? Is the **process flawed**? Can a **persistent coalition** be built? And the deciders are the government, the developer, and the lenders, with the courts, the European bodies, and the public as the pressure points.

Within a season you have moved from "the deal is signed" to a target list: make the cost-and-health case; cut off the financing; challenge the flawed process; and build the persistent coalition. That is a campaign, not a complaint — and it draws directly on how a coal plant was killed. Notice what the exercise did: it turned a sense that the deal was signed and the money lined up and nothing could be done into a set of concrete, workable tasks — make the cost-and-health case, cut off the financing, challenge the flawed process, build the persistent coalition — each tied to a specific lever that Kosovo genuinely provides. That reframing, from resignation before a signed concession to a plan built on the case, the money, and the process, is the difference the questions make, and the first, whether the project depends on international financing that can be cut off, together with the second, the strength of the cost-and-health case, often decides how strong a hand the campaign holds.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on. The lenders, a court, a European body, a journalist, and the

public all move on evidence, not indignation — and in Kosovo, the cost, the health harm, the financing, and the flawed process are precisely what a campaign turns into pressure, so document them well. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Project, the Financing, and the Process

Get the documents the project rests on. Obtain the **project details, the concession, the financing, and the approval** — and scrutinise them: who is financing it, on what terms, and is that financing **vulnerable**? Is the approval — the environmental assessment — **flawed or opaque**, approved without proper public consultation, as the Kosova e Re assessment was? Establish the financing and the flaws precisely, because the financing is the lifeline and the flaw is the legal opening.

Layer 2: The Cost, the Health Harm, and the People

Document the reality the paper understates, and put the **cost and the health harm** at the centre. Record the **cost to the public** — what the project will cost households and the state, the ruinous terms of any guaranteed price, as the cost of Kosova e Re was made plain. Record the **harm to health** — the air pollution, the disease, the toll on a population already breathing dirty air, as Kosovo's existing plants' toll was documented. Record the **harm to the land and the people**. Gather **expert evidence** on the economics and the health, because these are the arguments that move lenders and opinion. The cost and the health harm, in particular, deserve to be documented not as slogans but as rigorously costed and assessed facts, because they are the arguments that carry the most weight with the audiences that decide. Set out, with figures and expert analysis, exactly what the project will cost the public — the guaranteed price, the state guarantees, the burden on households and the budget over the life of the contract — and exactly what it will do to health — the pollutants, the exposure, the disease, the toll on a population already breathing dirty air. These are the facts that a development bank's own analysts must weigh, that a finance ministry cannot ignore, and that a journalist can turn into a front page. At Kosova e Re it was precisely the rigorous case on ruinous cost and severe health harm that helped turn the lenders and the argument; a community should build the same rigorous, quantified case for its own project.

Layer 3: The Financing, the Cost, and the Process

Finally, document the case. Does the project **depend on financing that can be cut off**? Is the **cost ruinous and the health harm severe** enough to turn lenders and opinion? And is the **process flawed** enough to challenge? Each is a separate ground — for the lenders, the courts, the European bodies, and the campaign — and together they make a case that is hard to wave away. This is the layer that most often decides Kosovar fights of this kind, because here a project is revealed to be too costly, too dirty, dependent on money that can be withdrawn, and approved through a flawed process — exactly the case that helped kill Kosova e Re, whose cost and health harm and flawed approval turned the lenders and the argument against it. Assembling all three grounds together — the ruinous cost, the severe health harm, and the flawed process, all aimed at a vulnerable financing — is what gives a Kosovar case its force, because each serves a different front and they reinforce one another: the cost turns the finance ministry and the lenders, the health harm rouses the public and the medical world, and the flawed process supplies the legal risk that a prudent lender must weigh. A campaign that establishes only one may leave the project a way through; one that establishes all three, aimed at the money, as the opponents of Kosova e Re did, can turn the lenders, the courts, the public, and the argument against the project at once — which is how a coal plant, long backed by an international lender, was finally starved of its financing.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

This is the practical companion to Step 2: the specific records that decide Kosovar cases of this kind, and where to obtain them. You will not need every item; you will need the few that establish the financing, the cost, the health harm, and the flawed process.

The Project, the Financing, and the Paper Trail

- **The project and the concession** — the project, its scale, and the developer's contract.
- **The financing** — the lenders, the guarantees, and the terms — the lifeline of the project.
- **The cost to the public** — the guaranteed price, the state guarantees, the burden on households.
- **The approval and the assessment** — the environmental assessment, the consultation, and any flaws.
- **The developer and the beneficiaries** — who is behind it, who profits, and their record.

How to Get Them

The project, the concession, the approval, and much of the financing are matters of record, obtainable from the government, the lenders' own disclosures, and public filings, and the flaws in an assessment are often exposed by scrutiny of the process, as the lack of consultation at Kosova e Re was exposed. Lean on **allies**: Kosovo's civil-society organisations and its international partners — the watchdogs of international financing, the energy and health experts — who know the lenders, the economics, and the European rules, as they knew them at Kosova e Re. Move promptly, and then endure: documenting the financing and the flaws early gives you the levers, and sustaining the case over years is what cuts off the money, as the opponents of Kosova e Re sustained it for a decade.

The Ground Evidence

- **The cost to the public** — the price, the guarantees, the burden, expertly costed.
- **The harm to health** — the air pollution, the disease, the toll, expertly assessed.
- **The financing's vulnerability** — the lenders' own rules and the project's dependence on them.
- **The flawed process** — the defective assessment, the lack of consultation.
- **Testimony and expertise** — from residents, and from economists, health experts, and lawyers.

Organise It So It Persuades

Keep a **master timeline** of the plan, the concession, the financing, the approval, and every step of the fight — the spine of any case or campaign, and, in a years-long fight, the memory that outlasts individuals. Keep a **document index** so any fact can be sourced in seconds. And keep an **argument bank** (developed in a later section) that pairs each fact with what it proves, to whom — the lenders, the courts, the European bodies, the press, the public. A well-ordered file is not bureaucracy; it is what lets a resident, an economist, a health expert, a lawyer, a lender, a journalist, and a judge all see the same clear picture fast, and it guards against the campaign's own worst enemy, a claim that cannot be sourced when the developer or the government pushes back. In Kosovo, the campaign with the better-documented case — above all the clearest proof of the ruinous cost, the health harm, and the flawed process — is very often the one that cuts off the financing and helps kill a project, as the opponents of Kosova e Re did. A shared, reliable record matters all the more in a fight that runs for years and passes through many hands, for the memory of what was promised, costed, and approved must outlast the individuals who first documented it. When a coalition spans many organisations, experts, journalists, and international allies over the better part of a decade, a common file — the concession, the financing, the guaranteed terms, the assessment, the flaws, all dated and sourced — is what lets a later generation of campaigners hold the government and the lenders to what was said long before, and what lets each speak accurately with one voice. The opposition to Kosova e Re endured in part because it kept such a shared record across the years; a campaign settling in for a long fight should build and preserve that common memory from the very start.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION — HOW TO BUILD THE PERSISTENT COALITION

Evidence does not win on its own. A broad, persistent coalition does — and in Kosovo, Kosova e Re proves that a civil-society alliance, sustained for nearly a decade and never letting up, can outlast a government's determination and help kill a project. A campaign's strength here is that breadth and that endurance: a coalition wide enough to cover cost, health, law, and financing, and durable enough to outlast the years.

Phase 1: The Core and the Case

Start with a committed core rooted in **civil-society organisations** — because in Kosovo the cost-and-health case and the financing lever are the strongest ground, and the coalition must be built to last. Assign roles — documentation, the cost-and-health case, the financing and lender pressure, the legal and European challenge, media, and coalition liaison. Agree on the goal — the financing cut off, the process challenged, the project killed — and on what the coalition will accept. Draw on the public's concern about cost and dirty air and the knowledge that this is a long fight.

Phase 2: The Broad, Persistent Coalition

Then widen deliberately, and build for the long haul. Bring in the **civil-society organisations** — the sustainable-development, environmental, and governance groups, and the investigative journalists — which bring the expertise, the campaigning, and the scrutiny, as Kosovo's civil-society consortium and its investigative reporters did at Kosova e Re; the **economists and health experts**, whose evidence on cost and health is decisive; the **international allies** — the watchdogs of international financing — who can reach the lenders; the affected **residents and communities**; the **wider**

public, who bear the cost and breathe the air; and, distinctively, the **European dimension** — the energy and environmental bodies Kosovo is bound to. Reach the **press**, at home and abroad. The Kosova e Re campaign drew its power from exactly this breadth and endurance — organisations, experts, journalists, and international allies, sustained for a decade — which is precisely the spread and staying power a Kosovar campaign of this kind needs. The endurance is worth dwelling on, because it is what most sets a Kosovar fight of this kind apart and what most often fails elsewhere. A campaign against a government's centrepiece project may take the better part of a decade, and it cannot rest on the energy of a few, who will tire or move on; it must be built as a standing coalition that renews itself, drawing in new organisations and new people as older ones step back, so the cause outlives any single champion and any one government. The opposition to Kosova e Re lasted nearly a decade precisely because it was a broad consortium with a shared case, a shared record, and shared international allies, larger than any one group. A campaign that expects a quick resolution builds for a sprint and collapses when the fight proves long; one that plans from the outset for a fight of years — renewing its people, preserving its record, sustaining its case to the lenders — is the one that can starve a project as Kosova e Re was starved.

A worked coalition example. Facing a big, financed project, the civil-society organisations form the core; economists and health experts supply the cost-and-health case; international financing watchdogs reach the lenders; investigative journalists expose the process; residents and the public bring the numbers and the stake; and the European bodies add a lever. No single group could carry it for a decade; together, and enduring, they cover the cost, the health, the law, and the money — the model Kosova e Re built.

Phase 3: Sustaining It for the Long Haul

Here Kosovo is distinctive: campaigns of this kind are **measured in years**, so endurance is the central task. Meet on a rhythm that can be kept for years. Renew the coalition, bringing in new people as others tire, so the cause outlasts any individual and any one government. Give people concrete tasks. Mark the wins that come — a lender's doubt, a flaw exposed, a lawsuit filed, a cost revealed — because in a long fight morale is sustained by real if partial gains. Keep the coalition broad and durable, and guard against the **discouragement of a fight against a determined government**, the **pressure and the delay**, and the temptation to give up before the financing cracks. The distinctive danger is exhaustion before the money is cut off; the distinctive strength is a coalition that keeps making the case until the lenders walk — as the opponents of Kosova e Re did over nearly a decade.

Phase 4: The Financing and the Endurance

Here is Kosovo's distinctive strength, on two levels. First, the **financing**: make the cost-and-health case **to the lenders and against the financing**, so that the international money — the development banks whose own rules can turn them against a dirty, costly project — is **cut off**, as the World Bank's and the European bank's withdrawals helped kill Kosova e Re. Second, the **endurance**: keep the case and the pressure going, **year after year**, until the financing cracks and the developer walks, as the Kosova e Re opponents did. Keep it **broad, persistent, and finance-focused**, because in Kosovo it is the sustained coalition making the cost-and-health case and cutting off the money, over the long haul, that helps kill a big project — as it helped kill Kosova e Re.

STEP 4: LEGAL CHALLENGES — THE COURTS, THE PROCESS, AND THE EUROPEAN BODIES

Kosovo's courts, its European commitments, and — distinctively — the pressure on the financing are a real toolkit. You do not need a single, final victory: a flawed approval challenged, a lender's doubt raised, a delay while you build the case, a European complaint lodged — each is a real gain, and together, sustained, they starve a project. Engage lawyers and the organisations early — but understand the tools.

The Flawed Process and the Courts

The first lever is the **flawed approval**. Where the environmental assessment or the process is **defective or opaque** — approved without proper public consultation, in breach of the rules, as at Kosova e Re — the **courts** can be asked to review it. Identify the flaw, bring the challenge, and a defective approval can be delayed or undone — and the challenge itself signals to lenders the legal risk of the project.

The European Bodies and the Rules

The second lever, distinctive to a country bound by European rules, is the **European dimension**. Kosovo is bound by **European energy and environmental commitments**, and a project that breaches them — a flawed assessment in breach of the European environmental-assessment rules, as alleged at Kosova e Re — can be **complained of to the relevant European energy body**. Use the European rules and the European bodies, which reach beyond the national government and add legal and reputational risk to a project. The European dimension is worth understanding precisely, because Kosovo's ties to the European energy and environmental framework give a campaign a forum and a set of standards beyond the reach of the national government. A project approved through a process that breaches the European environmental-assessment requirements — for instance, an assessment adopted without the public consultation those rules demand, as was alleged at Kosova e Re — can be complained of to the European energy body to which Kosovo is bound, which can examine the state's compliance. Such a complaint does not always yield a swift remedy, but it adds a serious legal and reputational risk to the project, signals that risk to the very lenders a campaign is trying to move, and keeps the flawed process in the public eye. A campaign should therefore treat the European route as both a legal lever and a means of reinforcing the pressure on the financing.

The Financing and the Lenders

The third lever, and the decisive one at Kosova e Re, is the **financing**. The international lenders — the development banks — have **their own rules and their own reputations**, and a strong case that a project is too costly, too dirty, and legally risky can move them to **withdraw**, as the World Bank and the European bank withdrew from Kosova e Re. Make the case to the lenders, through their own standards and your international allies, that the project is not the least-cost option and carries legal and reputational risk — and a project starved of financing may die. It is worth being precise about how this pressure is applied, because it is the distinctive craft of a Kosovar fight of this kind. One does not simply ask a lender to refuse; one builds, and then submits to the lender through its own procedures and through the international watchdogs who specialise in it, a case framed in the lender's own terms — that the project fails the least-cost test the bank is bound to apply, that it carries the legal risk of a flawed approval the bank cannot ignore, that it breaches the environmental and social standards the bank has committed to, that it exposes the bank to reputational damage as the world turns from coal. Presented in those terms, with rigorous evidence, the case gives the lender both the reason and the cover to withdraw. At Kosova e Re, this is in effect what happened: the case that the plant was no longer the least-cost option, among other things, moved the World Bank to step back. A campaign should learn the lenders' own rules and argue the project against them.

Where to Turn and With Whom

The process challenge goes through the **courts**; the European complaint through the **European energy and environmental bodies**; the financing pressure through the **lenders and your international allies**. Get help early: Kosovo's civil-society organisations, its international financing watchdogs, and its lawyers know the courts, the European rules, and the lenders, as they knew them at Kosova e Re. Help engaged early is worth far more than help sought after, and in Kosovo the strongest strategy marries the **process challenge and the European complaint** to the **cost-and-health case and the financing pressure**, so that a project is challenged in court, complained of in Europe, and starved of its money — as Kosova e Re was.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

You have a file of evidence. Now you must turn it into arguments — because the same fact persuades a lender, a court, a European body, a journalist, and the public in different ways. Learning to translate your evidence for each audience is what lets a community reach every lever at once.

One Fact, Many Arguments

Take a single documented fact — say, that a coal plant's guaranteed power price would burden households for twenty years while the plant poisons the air. That one fact becomes:

- **A financing argument:** the project is not the least-cost option and carries legal and reputational risk — the case that turns the lenders.
- **A cost argument:** households and the state would pay ruinously for decades — the case that turns opinion and the government.
- **A health argument:** the plant would poison an already dirty airshed — the case that rouses the public and the health world.
- **A process argument:** the approval was flawed and opaque — the case for the courts and the European bodies.

- **A climate argument:** a new fossil-fuel plant runs against the direction of policy and finance — the case that isolates it.

Same fact, five arguments, five audiences. Go through your strongest facts and, for each, ask what it proves to each audience. That table is your campaign's argument bank — and in Kosovo the arguments that most often decide things are the **financing** one, because it cuts off the money, and the **cost-and-health** one, because it turns opinion and lenders. Keep the arguments anchored to the same documented facts, so a claim made to a reporter can be backed in the record and a claim made to a lender or a court can be proven; consistency across audiences is itself persuasive.

Match the Argument to the Audience

The lenders respond to their own rules — the least-cost test, the environmental and legal risk — and to the reputational cost of a dirty project.

The courts want the flaw in the approval framed precisely against the rules, with the documents that prove it.

The European bodies want the breach of European energy or environmental rules framed against those rules.

Journalists need a specific, vivid story with a hook: a ruinously costly, air-poisoning plant on a flawed approval.

The public needs the argument clear and stirring: a plant we will pay dearly for, that will poison our air. The public argument, though it moves people most, must stay anchored to the documented facts if it is to serve the other fronts as well. The prospect of paying dearly for decades, and of breathing yet dirtier air, rouses a public rightly; but the same facts, stated precisely — the guaranteed price, the projected pollutants, the health toll — are also what the lenders and the courts require. A campaign that lets the public argument drift into exaggeration hands the developer an easy rebuttal and weakens the case built on the same ground. Keep the public argument vivid but true, so that the story that moves the public and the evidence that moves a lender or a court are one and the same, drawn from a single reliable record.

The government responds to the cost, the public opposition, the legal risk, and — as at Kosova e Re — a change of political will.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY — HOW COVERAGE SHIFTS OUTCOMES

Media is not vanity; it is a lever — and in Kosovo, where cost and dirty air are felt by everyone and a flawed deal is a story, coverage that carries the ruinous cost, the health harm, and the financing is among the most powerful levers of all. Coverage sustains the coalition, pressures the government and the lenders, and reaches the international stage. Kosova e Re became a national and international story in large part through the investigative press and the public attention the campaign drew — the exposés of the deal, the cost, the flawed approval.

Build the Story

Reporters and the public need specifics, and here they need the cost, the health harm, and the money. "A project is controversial" is not a story; "we will pay ruinously for twenty years for a plant that poisons our air, on a deal approved without consultation, backed by the World Bank" is — the kind of story that made Kosova e Re a national and international cause. Lead with your strongest verified facts — the cost, the health harm, the flawed approval, the financing — and offer a human voice: a resident breathing the air, an expert on the cost. In Kosovo the story of a ruinously costly, air-poisoning plant, on a flawed deal, is one the nation and the world respond to.

Reach the Right Outlets

Work outward in rings. **Local voices and the affected communities** first. Then the **national outlets** — because cost and dirty air are national concerns, and national opinion pressures the government, as it did over Kosova e Re. Then, distinctively, the **international ring** — the international press and the watchdogs of international financing — because a lender's involvement in a dirty project is an international story and an international lever. Feed each ring what it needs, and let coverage in one pull in the next. The **national and international rings are both decisive** here, because the money is international.

Sustain It, and Keep It True — for Years

A single article changes little; a drumbeat changes decisions — and a Kosovar fight of this kind runs for years. Plan a sequence — the deal, the cost, the flawed approval, the health harm, the lawsuit, the lender's doubt, the withdrawal — so there is always a next hook, and build your own clear record so the story endures as long as the fight. Keep messaging disciplined, accurate, and rigorous; the developer and the government will seize on any exaggeration, and a credible, cost-health-and-financing-centred campaign is what sustains a national and international cause. Verified, specific, cost-and-health-centred, financing-focused, and enduring — that is the coverage that shifts outcomes here, and that helped kill a coal plant.

EMAILS & LETTERS

Written communications are how you request, object, create a record, and reach the bodies that can act — the government, the lenders, the courts, the European bodies, and the press. Each does double duty: it asks for something and it documents that you asked. Keep copies of everything, and send important items so that receipt is provable. Below are adaptable templates for the situations you will meet most often. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the cost, the health harm, the financing, and the flawed process.

8A. Request for Information

To: the relevant ministry / agency **Subject:** Request for information on [project]

We, [community/organisation], request the **project details, the concession, the financing, the guaranteed terms, and the environmental assessment** for [project]. This affects the public's money and health, and we are entitled to the record. Please provide the documents.

8B. Objection to the Approval

To: the environment / planning authority **Subject:** Objection to [project] and its approval

We, [community/organisation], object to [project] and its approval. The environmental assessment is **flawed** — [approved without proper public consultation / in breach of the rules] — the project's **cost** to the public is ruinous, and its **harm to health** severe. We ask that the approval be **reviewed and refused**.

8C. Submission to the Lenders

To: the international lender / development bank **Subject:** Concerns regarding the financing of [project]

We, [community/organisation], write regarding your possible financing of [project]. The project is **not the least-cost option**, carries **legal and reputational risk** from a flawed approval, and would impose ruinous cost and severe health harm. We ask that you apply your own standards and **decline to finance it**, as the lenders declined to finance Kosova e Re.

8D. Complaint to the European Body

To: the relevant European energy / environmental body **Subject:** Breach of European rules in the approval of [project]

We, [community/organisation], submit that the approval of [project] **breaches European rules** — [the environmental-assessment rules / consultation requirements] to which Kosovo is bound. We request that the body examine the compliance, and attach the evidence.

8E. Instructing a Lawyer / Organisation

To: a civil-society organisation / environmental lawyer **Subject:** [Project] — the cost, the health harm, the financing, the flaw

We are opposing [project]. We attach the concession, the financing, the assessment, and our evidence on cost and health, and seek advice on **the process challenge, the European complaint, and the pressure on the financing**. Please advise on the strongest steps and the deadlines.

8F. Approach to the Coalition / Experts

To: experts and organisations **Subject:** Join us to stop [project]

We write to those who can help stop [project]: economists who can cost it, health experts who can assess it, financing watchdogs who can reach the lenders, and lawyers who can challenge it. As the opponents of Kosova e Re built a broad coalition and sustained it for a decade, we ask you to join us for the long haul.

8G. Email to a Reporter

To: [journalist] **Subject:** Story tip: [specific finding] — [the cost / the health harm / the deal]

I follow your coverage of [beat]. We have a national — and international — story, with a clear hook: [documents] show [finding — e.g. "we will pay ruinously for a plant that poisons our air, on a deal approved without consultation and backed by an international lender"]. It echoes Kosova e Re. I can share the file and connect you with a resident and an expert. Could we talk this week?

8H. Public Statement

To: the public and the authorities **Subject:** [Coalition] will stop [project]

We, [coalition], oppose [project], which would cost the public ruinously and poison our air, on a flawed approval. As the opponents of Kosova e Re made the cost-and-health case, cut off the international financing, challenged the flawed process, and sustained a coalition for a decade until the plant was cancelled, we will make the case, cut off the money, challenge the process, and endure. We will not relent.

Using the Templates Well

Send important communications so that receipt is provable, and log every one in your timeline — the record of an objection, a submission to a lender, or a complaint is itself evidence, and exactly what the government, the lenders, the courts, the European bodies, and the public will heed. Keep them factual, specific, and grounded in the cost, the health harm, the financing, and the flawed process; attach your evidence; and route them, where you can, through the organisations, the experts, your international allies, your lawyers, and the press. The reply, or the result, becomes part of your record, and in Kosovo that record feeds the levers that matter most: the cost-and-health case, the financing, the flawed process, and the persistent coalition that helped kill a coal plant.

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME OR FEW RESOURCES: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Not everyone can run a decade-long campaign. With a few hours a week you can still do real work to stop a destructive project — and in a long fight, steady effort is exactly what endures. In rough order of impact for the effort:

- 1. Establish the financing and the cost.** Find out who is financing it and what it will cost the public (Step 1, 8A).
- 2. Build a durable core.** Bring in the civil-society organisations and the experts, and build to last (Step 3, 8E).
- 3. Make the cost-and-health case.** Document and publicise the ruinous cost and the health harm (Step 2).
- 4. Reach the lenders.** Put the case to the international lenders and their watchdogs (8C).
- 5. Challenge the flawed process.** With a lawyer, take a defective approval to court and to Europe (8B, 8D).
- 6. Reach the press — national and international.** Take the story out (8G).
- 7. Endure.** Keep the coalition and the case going, year after year, until the financing cracks.

Do only the first three and you will have established the financing, built a durable core, and made the cost-and-health case — the foundation of a Kosovar campaign of this kind. Then come back and read the rest. Even the shortest version has a spine: establish the financing, build a durable core, make the cost-and-health case.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Kosovo's system, as a young state with an active civil society, courts, a free press, and European commitments, is by many measures open to a community opposing a destructive project — but it is tilted in specific ways you must understand, so you neither waste effort nor grow discouraged in a long fight.

Where the Tilt Shows

The tilt here is real. **Powerful energy and development interests**, and the government's own determination to build a centrepiece project, carry great weight. **Governance weaknesses** — opaque deals, flawed approvals, weak consultation, as at Kosova e Re — favour the proponent. **The reliance on coal** and the pressure of energy shortages push toward dirty projects. And the fight can be **long and wearing** against a determined government. Where these tilts bite, a campaign that assumes a signed deal cannot be undone, or that gives up before the financing cracks, will be disappointed — which is precisely why the distinctive strategy is to make the cost-and-health case, cut off the financing, challenge the flawed process, and endure.

What Still Works — And Some Is Strong

The decisive point is that even against this tilt, Kosovo's levers are real, and some are strong.

The cost-and-health case still turns opinion and lenders. A ruinous, dirty project is vulnerable to the argument.

The financing lever still starves a project. International lenders with their own rules can be moved to withdraw.

The flawed-process challenge still bites. A defective approval can be taken to court and to Europe.

The persistent coalition still outlasts a government. A decade of opposition wore down a centrepiece project.

The European dimension still opens. Kosovo's European commitments are a lever beyond the national government.

The Honest Frame

So the honest frame for Kosovo is realistic and clear-eyed: this may be a long fight, the win may be a confluence, and the win may be defensive — but the cost-and-health case, the financing lever, the flawed-process challenge, and the persistent coalition give a community real, and sometimes strong, levers, and cutting off a dirty project's money and helping to kill it is a real victory, even if shared and unfinished. So diagnose your fight honestly: make the **cost-and-health case**; cut off the **financing**; challenge the **flawed process**; build the **persistent coalition**; and endure. Do not assume a signed deal cannot be undone, or give up before the money cracks; Kosova e Re was killed because a broad, persistent coalition made the case and cut off the financing over nearly a decade — even as the old plants kept running.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO IS CAPTURED

Kosovo has had real and documented concerns about opaque deals, flawed approvals, and the closeness of powerful interests to power, so this section matters. When a project is driven not by the public interest but by a costly, opaque deal, or approved through a flawed process, your strategy includes exposing that.

How to Tell

Look for the signatures of a costly or captured deal. A **ruinously costly contract** favouring the developer over the public, as critics said of the Kosova e Re power-purchase agreement; an **environmental approval rushed or hidden**, without proper public consultation, as at Kosova e Re; an **opaque concession** whose full terms are kept from the public; **close ties** between the developer, the officials, and the powerful; and **benefits to the few** while the public pays and breathes the pollution. Trace the deal and the process: how the concession was granted, what it guarantees the developer, and whether the approval was sound. In Kosovo, a costly, opaque deal, or a rushed approval, is worth examining for the interests behind it.

Who Can Be Captured — and Who Is Harder

Be clear-eyed about where capture reaches. **Parts of the government and the approval process** can produce opaque deals and flawed approvals, or be pressured by powerful interests. But some forces are far harder to capture, and they are your targets: the **courts**; the **international lenders**, whose own rules can turn them against a project; the **European**

bodies, beyond national reach; the **civil-society organisations and investigative press**; and, above all, the **broad, persistent public coalition**. Distinctively, the international lenders and the European bodies are powerful checks beyond national capture, and a project that depends on their money is vulnerable to their standards. Your task is to document the flaw and the cost, and bring them to the lenders, the courts, the European bodies, the press, and the public.

What to Do

Do not assume a costly, opaque, or flawed deal cannot be undone. Instead, **document it precisely** — the ruinous cost, the flawed approval, the opaque terms, the interest served — and take it to the forces that can act: the **lenders**; the **courts**; the **European bodies**; the **investigative press**; and the **broad public**. Pair the exposure with the cost-and-health case, so the flawed deal and the harm to the public arrive together. In Kosovo, exposing a costly, opaque deal and a flawed approval, and taking them to the lenders and the public, is often the way to cut off the money and kill the project — as the exposure of Kosova e Re's cost and flawed approval helped turn the lenders and the argument against it. Do this with care, for exposing the powerful invites pushback.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE

The five steps win when they run together — and, in Kosovo, when they run for the long haul. Here is how they fit across the life of a fight, which turns on the cost-and-health case, the financing, the flawed process, and the persistent coalition.

Early (Months 0-12): The Financing, the Case, and the Coalition

Pin down the project and the deciding bodies (Step 1); document the **financing, the cost, the health harm, and the flawed process** (Step 2). Build the **durable coalition** — organisations, experts, journalists, international allies — designed to last (Step 3). Move at once on what is decisive: **request the information** (8A); **object to the approval** (8B); **put the case to the lenders** (8C); reach **organisations, experts, and lawyers** early (8E). This phase lays the foundation, and in Kosovo the financing exposed, the case built, and the coalition formed here are what endure.

Middle (Years): Make the Case, Cut the Money, Challenge the Process

Sustain and renew the coalition for the long haul (Step 3). Turn your evidence into arguments for each audience (Turning Evidence). Press the **cost-and-health case to the lenders**, challenge the **flawed process** in court and to the European bodies (Step 4). Build the media drumbeat, national and international (Step 5). Each front feeds the others. Do the time-critical things at once — the lawsuit within its deadline, the case to the lenders before they commit — because those chances are most powerful when seized promptly.

Later (Years): The Withdrawal, the Cancellation, and Vigilance

Pursue the decisive outcome — the **financing cut off, the process challenged, the project cancelled** — and then stay vigilant, because, as Kosovo shows, a government may seek other investors, and the underlying problem may remain. Judge success honestly. Sometimes it is a lender's withdrawal that starves the project, as at Kosova e Re. Sometimes it is a developer walking away, as at Kosova e Re. Both, where they stop the project, are victories worth the long fight — even if the old plants keep running and the work is unfinished.

The Shape of a Campaign

MONTHS 0-12	Expose financing + cost + flaw Build a durable coalition Object Put the case to the lenders
YEARS	Sustain the coalition Cost-and-health case to lenders Challenge the process Media (national + international)
LATER	Financing cut off / project cancelled Stay vigilant -- other investors, unfinished business

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Kosovo gives communities a genuinely powerful — and distinctive — set of tools, and the honest measure of this guide is how squarely it faces both their strength and their limits.

The strengths are real and distinctive. The **cost-and-health case** — that a project is too expensive and too dirty — turns opinion, government, and lenders against it. The **financing lever** — cutting off the international money by making that case to lenders whose own rules can be turned against a project — can starve a project to death. The **flawed-process**

challenge — the lawsuit and the European complaint over a defective approval — delays and undermines it. And the **persistent coalition** — a broad civil-society alliance sustained for a decade — can outlast a government's determination. These are the tools that helped kill Kosova e Re.

The limits are just as real, and this guide names them. The cancellation was a **confluence** — the civil-society campaign mattered, but so did the collapsing economics of coal, the lenders' withdrawal, and a new government's opposition; the plant's death was over-determined. The win was in part **defensive** — the new plant was stopped, but the old, dirty plants still run, and the deeper energy and air problem is unresolved. And the decisive lever — cutting off the financing — worked because the project **depended on international money**, which not every project does. No guide should pretend these away; in Kosovo, the art is to make the cost-and-health case, cut off the financing, challenge the flawed process, build the persistent coalition, and keep fighting, because starving a dirty project of its money and helping to kill it is a real victory, even a shared and unfinished one.

So the realistic promise is this: **make the cost-and-health case; cut off the financing; challenge the flawed process; build the persistent coalition — and endure — running all of it together.** Do that, and where a project depends on international money and the case is strong, you can cut off its financing and help kill it, as the opponents of Kosova e Re did; where a project is self-financed or the case thin, you can still win delay, a record, and the case made. Do it as they did — a broad, persistent coalition that made the case and cut off the money over nearly a decade.

A last word on the case and the endurance. Kosovo's lesson is that a persistent civil-society coalition — that makes the case on cost and health, cuts off the international financing, and challenges the flawed process — can help kill a big, destructive project; but that the win may be shared with the economics and the politics, may be defensive, and may leave the deeper problem unresolved. The powerful count on your believing the deal is signed and the money is lined up and nothing can be done, or on outlasting you across the years. Their advantage is the determination to build, the energy pressure, and the long grind. Yours is the case on cost and health, the international financing that can be cut off, the flawed process that can be challenged, the European bodies beyond national reach, the persistent coalition, and the proven fact that the opponents of Kosova e Re cut off the money and helped kill the plant. Play to that — and endure. Keep the record and the proof of the cost, the health harm, and the flaw, keep the coalition broad and durable, put the case to the lenders, challenge the process, and treat every lender's doubt, every flaw exposed, every cost revealed, and every year the project is delayed as a stone in a wall that starves the project of its money.

The tools are here, and Kosova e Re itself proved them, honestly and incompletely: a large coal plant, planned for over a decade and long backed by an international lender, opposed by a broad civil-society coalition that made the case — on ruinous cost, on the harm to an already dirty airshed, on a flawed and opaque approval — that helped move the World Bank and the main European bank to withdraw their support, took the defective approval to court and to a European body, and sustained the pressure until, with the economics of coal collapsed and a new government opposed, the developer, unable to finance it, walked away and the plant was cancelled; a plant stopped, though the old plants still run. What decides the outcome, in the end, is the strength of the cost-and-health case, the vulnerability of the financing, the flaw in the process, and the endurance of the coalition — and those a determined public can summon and sustain. Begin today, begin with the financing and the case and the coalition, and build from there. Communities before you have starved a big project of its money and helped kill it — a coal plant cancelled, its financing cut off, its flawed deal exposed. What the opponents of Kosova e Re did can be done again. So can yours.